

# LUIS HENRIQUE RIBEIRO LINHARES

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## EDUCATION

Ph.D., Economics, Boston University, Boston MA, May 2027 (expected)  
M.Sc., Economics, São Paulo School of Economics, São Paulo, Brazil, 2021  
M.A., Economics, São Paulo School of Economics, São Paulo, Brazil, 2018  
B.E., Industrial Engineering, University of São Paulo, São Paulo, Brazil, 2013

## FIELDS OF INTEREST

Microeconomic Theory, Decision Theory, Industrial Organization

## WORKING PAPERS

[“Strategic Obfuscation: Influence Through Information Costs,”](#) (with Daniel Monte) Job Market Paper. September 2026

## WORK IN PROGRESS

“An Axiomatic Approach to Conformity,” September 2026  
“Uncertain Prices and Competition: Who Absorbs the Risk?” May 2025

## PRESENTATIONS

New England Economics PhD Conference, 2026  
3B (BU, BC, Brown) Theory Workshop, 2025  
Theory Workshop, Boston University, 2024  
3B (BU, BC, Brown) Theory Workshop, 2023  
Thesis/Dissertation Seminar, FGV, 2020

## FELLOWSHIPS AND AWARDS

Research Grant, Institute for Economic Development (BU), 2025  
CAPES Scholarship, CAPES, 2020  
Merit Scholarship for 6<sup>th</sup> place at 2019 ANPEC, São Paulo School of Economics, 2020  
CAPES Scholarship, CAPES, 2019  
Merit Scholarship for 6<sup>th</sup> place at 2019 ANPEC, São Paulo School of Economics, 2019  
Best Product Design Award (2<sup>nd</sup> place), Procter & Gamble, 2012

## WORK EXPERIENCE

### ACADEMIC

Research Assistant for Krishna Dasaratha, Boston University, 2026  
Research Assistant for Chiara Margaria, Boston University, 2025  
Research Assistant for Krishna Dasaratha, Boston University, 2024  
Research Assistant for Juan Ortner, Boston University, 2023-2024  
Research Assistant for Guilherme Lichand, University of Zurich, 2019-2020

**INDUSTRY**

Cartes Consulting & Training, São Paulo, Brazil, 2015-2019  
Founder, Instructor & Consultant (Day-to Day Data Management Advisory and Training)  
KPMG, São Paulo, Brazil, 2014  
Trainee (Management Consulting)  
Vital Work, São Paulo, Brazil, 2013-2014  
Marketing Analyst (Corporate Wellness Advisory)

**REFeree EXPERIENCE**

Brazilian Review of Econometrics

**ACADEMIC SERVICE**

Webmaster for ThReD (Theoretical Research in Development Economics)  
Co-organizer of Theory Reading Group

**TEACHING EXPERIENCE**

Instructor of Record, Sophomore Tutorial, Department of Economics, Harvard University, Fall 2026  
Teaching Fellow, Introduction to Mathematical and Computational Economics (Graduate), Department of Economics, Boston University, Fall 2025  
Instructor of Record, PhD Math Camp, Department of Economics, Boston University, Summer 2025  
Instructor of Record, Market Structure and Economic Performance, Department of Economics, Boston University, Summer 2024  
Teaching Fellow, Microeconomic Theory (Graduate), Department of Economics, Boston University, Spring 2023  
Teaching Fellow, Introduction to Microeconomics, Department of Economics, Boston University, Fall 2022  
Teaching Fellow, Mathematics for Economists (Graduate), São Paulo School of Economics, Brazil, 2020  
Teaching Fellow, Interpretations of Brazil, São Paulo School of Economics, Brazil, 2020  
Teaching Fellow, Projects I, São Paulo School of Economics, Brazil, 2019

**LANGUAGES:** English (Fluent), Portuguese (Native), Spanish (Fluent), French (Intermediate)

**COMPUTER SKILLS:** STATA, R, Python, MATLAB, LaTeX, Mathematica, VBA

**CITIZENSHIP/VISA STATUS:** Brazil, Portugal, Green Card (USA)

**REFERENCES**

**Professor Jawwad Noor**  
Department of Economics  
Boston University  
Phone: (617) 353-4436  
Email: [jnoor@bu.edu](mailto:jnoor@bu.edu)

**Professor Juan Ortner**  
Department of Economics  
Boston University  
Phone: (617) 358-4352  
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**Professor Krishna Dasaratha**  
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Boston University  
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## **Strategic Obfuscation: Influence Through Information Costs** (Job Market Paper)

*(with Daniel Monte)*

We develop a model of strategic obfuscation in which an interested Principal chooses the cost for a rationally inattentive Decision Maker to process information, making learning costs endogenous. We characterize when the Principal chooses transparency, total obfuscation (no-learning), or partial learning. Endogenous information costs can lead to a counterintuitive implication: increasing the Decision Maker's cost of mistakes can improve her resulting welfare as it leads the Principal to favor more transparency. The framework links persuasion and rational inattention, shifting attention from commitment in disclosure to the design of information costs. The model rationalizes fine print, product complexity, and has implications for disclosure and transparency policy.

## **Uncertain Prices and Competition: Who Absorbs the Risk**

I study the effects of uncertain prices on competition by risk-neutral firms producing the same homogeneous good. Prices may be uncertain due to exogenous shocks (such as tariffs on imported inputs) that are not yet observed at the time of purchase. Consumers are risk-averse and know they do not observe the real price, so they must make consumption decisions based on a price distribution. Firms choose whether to absorb the shock and offer a fixed price or allow the price to vary according to the shock realization. I find that competition pushes towards uncertainty. While a monopolist would choose to absorb all the price risk, two firms competing à la Bertrand prefer uncertain prices as the risk-averse consumer hedges by buying from both firms. This allows the competing firms to price above marginal cost.

## **An Axiomatic Approach to Conformity**

I provide a behavioral characterization of conformity when individuals have social concerns, as modeled in Bernheim (1994). The problem bridges decision and game theory in a novel way, as the agents' utility function explicitly incorporates an object that is endogenously determined in equilibrium: when agents care about how others perceive them, the equilibrium choice of one type affects the inference function that guides how all other types are judged and, consequently, their payoffs. I first establish a representation theorem using standard decision-theoretic tools, treating the inference function as exogenous. To endogenize the inference function, I describe the necessary restrictions on the utility function to ensure that there exists an action profile that is consistent with both utility maximization and the corresponding inference function.